

Tableau File Types

File type	Meaning	Contains	Main use case
.twb	Tableau Workbook	XML describing sheets, dashboards, calculations, formatting, data connections	Save/edit a workbook without embedding the actual data
.twbx	Tableau Packaged Workbook	.twb + packaged supporting files/data	Share or move a complete workbook easily
.tds	Tableau Data Source	Connection information, metadata, calculations, aliases, formatting	Reuse a data-source definition across workbooks
.tdsx	Tableau Packaged Data Source	.tds + local/extract data and supporting files	Share a data source together with its data

Easy way to remember

- TW B → **Workbook** definition
- TW BX → Workbook + **everything packaged**
- TD S → **Data Source** definition
- TD SX → Data Source + **data packaged**

Example

Suppose your Tableau dashboard connects to an Excel file:

- **.twb** → dashboard instructions + connection details; Excel file remains separate.
- **.twbx** → dashboard + **.twb** + packaged Excel/extract, making it easier to send to someone.
- **.tds** → reusable definition of how Tableau connects to that Excel/database and its metadata.
- **.tdsx** → **.tds** plus packaged local data/extract.

Key distinction: **TW*** files are primarily **workbooks**, while **TD*** files are **data sources**.
The **X** generally means **packaged**.